

ABC LTD. COMPANY – HUMAN RESOURCE POLICIES MANUAL

1. CODE OF CONDUCT AND ETHICAL STANDARDS

1.1. Core Values and Professionalism

- **Maintain integrity:** Employees must act honestly, ethically, and transparently in all business dealings.
- **Respect the workplace:** Treat all colleagues, clients, and partners with dignity and professional courtesy.
- **Protect representation:** Do not compromise the reputation of ABC Ltd. through personal public actions.
- **Prioritize accountability:** Take full ownership of assigned duties, deadlines, and operational outputs.

1.2. Conflict of Interest

- **Disclose external affiliations:** Report any personal financial interests in suppliers, competitors, or clients immediately.
- **Restrict secondary employment:** Full-time employees cannot accept outside jobs without written HR approval.
- **Refuse personal gain:** Do not use corporate positions to secure advantages for family or friends.
- **Manage close relationships:** Relatives cannot work in direct reporting lines or matching finance teams.

1.3. Gift and Entertainment Policy

- **Enforce value caps:** Employees cannot accept gifts from business parties exceeding a market value of ₹2,000.
- **Prohibit cash equivalents:** Gift cards, vouchers, and cash loans are strictly forbidden under all circumstances.
- **Mandate registry logging:** All accepted corporate gifts must be declared to HR via the compliance portal.
- **Restrict high-value hospitality:** Vendor-sponsored trips require pre-clearance from the respective Department Head and HR.

2. EQUAL EMPLOYMENT OPPORTUNITY & ANTI-HARASSMENT

2.1. Prevention of Sexual Harassment (POSH)

- **Enforce zero tolerance:** ABC Ltd. prohibits any form of unwelcome sexual advances, requests, or conduct.
- **Establish Internal Committee:** A dedicated Internal Committee (IC) handles all informal and formal POSH complaints.
- **Protect filing privacy:** All investigation details, witness testimonies, and identities remain strictly confidential.
- **Ban retaliatory actions:** Retaliation against any employee who files a harassment complaint results in termination.

2.2. Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI)

- **Govern unbiased hiring:** Recruiters must evaluate candidates solely on merit, skills, and role fit.
- **Protect identity groups:** Discrimination based on race, gender, religion, age, or disability is banned.
- **Ensure equitable pay:** Salaries and performance bonuses map directly to job bands and measurable achievements.
- **Accommodate cultural needs:** The company provides inclusive spaces, including nursing rooms and quiet prayer areas.

2.3. Anti-Discrimination Framework

- **Apply uniform standards:** Promotions, transfers, and training access depend strictly on documented performance metrics.
- **Eliminate systemic bias:** Panel interviews are mandatory for all hiring and internal progression tracks.
- **Report unfair treatment:** Employees can bypass direct managers to report discriminatory behavior to HR.
- **Enforce corrective actions:** Violations of anti-discrimination rules trigger formal demotions or immediate contract dismissal.

3. INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY & CONFIDENTIALITY

3.1. Non-Disclosure Agreements (NDA)

- **Sign upon onboarding:** Every employee must execute a comprehensive NDA before receiving corporate credentials.
- **Protect corporate data:** Proprietary code, client lists, and financial strategies cannot leave internal systems.

- **Maintain post-exit secrecy:** Confidentiality obligations remain legally binding after an employee leaves ABC Ltd.
- **Govern third-party data:** Treat partner and client data with identical security protocols as internal data.

3.2. Ownership of Intellectual Property

- **Assign automatic ownership:** All designs, code, and inventions created during employment belong to ABC Ltd.
- **Mandate invention disclosure:** Employees must document and disclose all work-related discoveries to the legal team.
- **Sign waiver forms:** Workers waive moral rights to corporate inventions developed using company resource pools.
- **Govern personal projects:** Side projects created entirely outside work hours without company assets remain personal.

3.3. Data Protection and GDPR/DPDP Compliance

- **Classify storage tiers:** Customer and employee personal data must be stored on encrypted server networks.
- **Limit user access:** Data access maps strictly to role requirements using the least-privilege principle.
- **Prohibit local extraction:** Downloading client personally identifiable information (PII) to personal devices is forbidden.
- **Report security breaches:** Staff must flag suspected data leaks to the IT Security Officer within 1 hour.

4. PERFORMANCE MANAGEMENT & APPRAISAL

4.1. Objective Setting (KPIs & OKRs)

- **Define targets annually:** Managers and employees must co-create measurable key performance indicators by Q1.
- **Align strategic goals:** Individual targets must directly support departmental and broad ABC Ltd. milestones.
- **Review goals mid-year:** Formal mid-term checks allow teams to calibrate goals based on market shifts.
- **Document metric changes:** Any adjustments to core performance expectations require formal updates in HR software.

4.2. Appraisal Process and Feedback

- **Execute quarterly check-ins:** Managers must provide constructive feedback sessions outside annual cycles.
- **Run 360-degree reviews:** Evaluation cycles compile feedback from peers, direct reports, and functional leads.
- **Standardize scoring scales:** Performance ratings use a calibrated 1-to-5 scale to reduce grading bias.
- **Provide appeal windows:** Employees can contest appraisal ratings by filing a formal appeal with HR.

4.3. Performance Improvement Plan (PIP)

- **Trigger formal PIPs:** Underperforming employees receive a structured, written 30-to-60-day corrective plan.
 - **Outline clear milestones:** The PIP document defines explicit goals, weekly support meetings, and success metrics.
 - **Monitor progress weekly:** Managers must log written performance updates after every weekly sync session.
 - **Define final outcomes:** Failing a PIP results in role reassignment, demotion, or termination of employment.
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5. INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY & CYBERSECURITY

5.1. Acceptable Use of Assets

- **Assign hardware ownership:** All laptops, phones, and peripherals remain the exclusive property of ABC Ltd.
- **Ban personal software:** Employees cannot install unapproved third-party applications on corporate machines.
- **Monitor company networks:** ABC Ltd. reserves the right to inspect device traffic and stored files.
- **Enforce safe browsing:** Accessing illegal, inappropriate, or high-risk streaming sites on work assets is prohibited.

5.2. Password and Access Security

- **Mandate complex phrases:** Passwords must feature a minimum of 14 characters, numbers, and symbols.

- **Enforce MFA protocols:** Multi-factor authentication is compulsory for accessing all internal corporate applications.
- **Rotate system credentials:** Employees must change system access passwords every 90 days without exception.
- **Prohibit credential sharing:** Sharing login details or access badges with colleagues triggers immediate discipline.

5.3. Remote Work Security

- **Require VPN connections:** Remote staff must connect via secure corporate VPNs for all tasks.
 - **Secure home environments:** Employees must ensure unauthorized individuals cannot view active corporate laptop screens.
 - **Ban public Wi-Fi:** Working from open public networks without encrypted hotspot connections is restricted.
 - **Manage hardware losses:** Report lost or stolen corporate laptops to IT within 2 hours for remote wiping.
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6. WORKPLACE HEALTH AND SAFETY

6.1. Ergonomics and Environment

- **Provide standard setups:** ABC Ltd. equips offices with adjustable ergonomic chairs and dual monitors.
- **Request desk assessments:** Employees may request specialized ergonomic evaluations from the facilities team.
- **Maintain climate control:** Office spaces adhere to strict international indoor air quality and temperature standards.
- **Promote active breaks:** The company encourages short micro-breaks every hour to prevent physical strain.

6.2. Emergency Protocols

- **Conduct bi-annual drills:** All workers must participate in scheduled fire, earthquake, and evacuation exercises.
- **Clear exit pathways:** Hallways, emergency doors, and fire extinguishers must remain completely unobstructed.
- **Deploy first-aid wardens:** Every floor maintains certified medical first-aid wardens during operational hours.

- **Report physical injuries:** Log any workplace injury on the HR portal within 24 hours for compensation tracking.

6.3. Substance Abuse Prevention

- **Ban alcohol possession:** Bringing alcohol onto company premises is illegal, excluding approved corporate events.
 - **Enforce smoke-free campuses:** Smoking and vaping are restricted strictly to designated outdoor ventilation zones.
 - **Prohibit illicit drugs:** Possession, sale, or consumption of illegal substances causes immediate police escalation.
 - **Mandate testing triggers:** Reasonable suspicion of intoxication during work hours justifies immediate medical screening.
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7. GRIEVANCE REDRESSAL MECHANISM

7.1. Informal Resolution Step

- **Encourage direct dialogue:** Employees should first attempt to resolve minor peer conflicts via open discussion.
- **Involve line managers:** Managers act as neutral mediators to resolve operational friction within 5 days.
- **Document informal outcomes:** Brief summaries of resolved issues should be emailed to HR for recording.
- **Escalate unresolved items:** If informal steps fail, employees can transition immediately to formal channels.

7.2. Formal Grievance Filing

- **Submit written notices:** File formal complaints via the secure grievance module on the HR platform.
- **Detail factual evidence:** Submissions must include specific dates, occurrences, witnesses, and supporting documentation.
- **Acknowledge receipt promptly:** The HR department will confirm receipt of complaints within 24 business hours.
- **Assign neutral investigators:** HR appoints an objective investigator unconnected to the involved business unit.

7.3. Investigation and Resolution Timeline

- **Launch prompt inquiries:** Official investigations begin within 3 business days of the formal filing date.
 - **Conduct separate interviews:** Investigators interview the complainant, respondent, and witnesses individually.
 - **Deliver final findings:** The investigation panel submits its report and decisions within 15 business days.
 - **Provide appeal windows:** Dissatisfied parties can appeal decisions to executive leadership within 5 days.
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8. RECRUITMENT AND ONBOARDING

8.1. Hiring Approvals

- **Mandate budget clearance:** Departments must secure written finance approval before raising hiring requisitions.
- **Standardize job descriptions:** HR verifies all job postings to ensure neutral, bias-free language.
- **Enforce panel interviews:** Every candidate must be vetted by at least three qualified internal interviewers.
- **Verify compensation parity:** Offer packages must fit structural pay bands to preserve internal equity.

8.2. Background Verification (BGV)

- **Initiate mandatory checks:** Third-party agencies verify employment history, degrees, and criminal records.
- **Issue conditional offers:** All employment offers depend entirely on receiving successful BGV clearances.
- **Manage background discrepancies:** Discovered resume fraud triggers immediate revocation of active employment offers.
- **Collect personal references:** Candidates must supply two professional references from previous line managers.

8.3. Probation and Confirmation

- **Set standard periods:** New hires undergo a mandatory 6-month probation period from their start date.
- **Conduct monthly reviews:** Managers provide structured performance assessments at day 30, 90, and 150.

- **Extend probation terms:** ABC Ltd. can extend probation by 3 months if performance targets remain unmet.
 - **Issue official confirmation:** Probation ends only when HR issues an official written Confirmation Letter.
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9. SEPARATION AND OFFBOARDING

9.1. Resignation Notice Periods

- **Enforce notice terms:** Confirmed employees must serve a 60-day notice period upon resignation.
- **Submit via HR portal:** Resignations are valid only when submitted formally through the employee portal.
- **Manage notice buyouts:** Company leadership must explicitly approve any financial buyouts of notice periods.
- **Restrict leave usage:** Employees cannot apply for planned vacation time during active notice periods.

9.2. Exit Interviews and Feedback

- **Schedule mandatory syncs:** HR schedules confidential exit interviews during the employee's final week.
- **Compile attrition metrics:** Feedback trends are anonymized and reviewed quarterly by executive leadership.
- **Return company property:** Employees must hand over all laptops, badges, and tokens to secure clearance.
- **Revoke system access:** IT terminates all network credentials at exactly 6:00 PM on the final working day.

9.3. Full and Final (F&F) Settlement

- **Process payout timelines:** Final financial settlements are disbursed within 30 days of the last working day.
- **Recover outstanding balances:** Any unreturned asset costs or salary advances are deducted from the F&F.
- **Issue service certificates:** Experience certificates are released electronically alongside the final F&F receipt.
- **Withhold disputed funds:** Disputed asset items pause settlement processing until resolving structural balances.

10. DISCIPLINARY POLICY AND ACTIONS

10.1. Progressive Discipline Tiers

- **Level 1: Verbal Warning:** Issued for minor performance lapses or first-time attendance infractions.
- **Level 2: Written Warning:** Documented in the employee's file for repeated minor offenses.
- **Level 3: Suspension:** Temporary unpaid suspension during active investigations into serious misconduct.
- **Level 4: Termination:** Permanent separation implemented for severe policy breaches or failed PIPs.

10.2. Gross Misconduct Criteria

- **Define zero-tolerance acts:** Theft, physical violence, fraud, and corporate espionage constitute gross misconduct.
- **Bypass progressive steps:** Gross misconduct triggers immediate termination without notice or buyout pay.
- **File legal escalations:** ABC Ltd. pursues civil or criminal legal remedies for financial fraud.
- **Forfeit terminal benefits:** Termination for gross misconduct forfeits standard discretionary severance packages.

10.3. Appeals and Review Board

- **Submit appeal requests:** Employees can appeal severe disciplinary actions to HR within 3 days.
- **Convene Review Boards:** A neutral three-member executive panel evaluates contested disciplinary decisions.
- **Review active evidence:** The board analyzes original investigation files, testimonies, and new defense entries.
- **Issue binding verdicts:** The Disciplinary Review Board's final written ruling overrides all previous decisions.